



Angie: Everyday struggling when learning new skills

I'm Angie, I'm a Program Manager of Engineering at Google. I'm currently working on the Data Analytics certificate. Previously, I was a researcher in people analytics. I was also what I call an analytical **mercenary** working for a lot of different companies to help them make sense of their data. Every time I learn a new skill, I feel like I'm learning how to speak all over again. I remember the first time I learned SQL, I was so frustrated because everyone around me, it felt like they were fluent, they knew exactly what they were doing. I remember struggling with the most basic things, just like getting the data out of the table or I remember somebody asked me just to find an average of something and I kept on getting an error. It really does feel like you're learning a new language and you're at toddler level and everyone around you is like maybe fluent. My parents immigrated to this country when they are in their 30s. After they had learned another language and they had to start over and learn English. I remember as a child watching them struggle every day to pick up a new language, to do really basic things, like ask for help at the grocery store. I remember calling the cable

company when I was six, asking them questions about the bill because my parents couldn't. I remember how hard they worked to learn this new language and to become fluent and every time I'm learning a new data language like SQL or R, I think about how hard that must have been. I think if they can do that, I can learn SQL. If they can ask for help for the most basic of things, I can ask the Data

Analysts next to me how to write a SQL statement and how to get data out of a table. That really helped me, is just having that mindset and knowing that I can ask for help.